

After Talks Flounder, Trump Threatens to Blockade Strait



THE OPTIONS As Vice President JD Vance left Pakistan, the U.S. was faced with more lengthy negotiations with Tehran or resuming a war that has already created a huge energy disruption.



THE STRAIT OF HORMUZ The Iranian foreign ministry said reopening the artery was among the first issues discussed, along with “the nuclear issue, war reparations” and the lifting of sanctions.



THE NUCLEAR PROGRAM The vice president suggested that he had handed Iran a take-it-or-leave-it proposal to forever give up its initiative. “They have chosen not to accept our terms,” he said.



THE PRESIDENT While the talks collapsed, President Trump was watching a U.F.C. fight in Miami. On his way there, he said it did not matter if a deal with Iran was reached: “We win, regardless.”

In a Lebanese City Targeted by Israel, Daily Life Is Torn Apart

By **CHRISTINA GOLDBAUM** and **HWAIDA SAAD**

TYRE, Lebanon — The mother sat on the curb outside a hospital in southern Lebanon, holding her phone and pleading with a photo of her sons on its screen.

“I’m waiting for you, answer me, answer me,” the woman, Fatima Kholeif, cried. “I’m your mother, just answer me.”

Her relatives huddled around her, unsure of what to do. When one tried to coax the phone from Ms. Kholeif’s hands to calm her down, she just clutched it harder. *Didn’t they understand?* The photos were all she had left of her sons — the sons who had just bought her hair dye so she could color her wispy, gray curls, a respite from the Israeli bombing. The sons who had kissed her cheeks that morning as they left for work harvesting oranges in an orchard nearby. The sons who were killed on that orchard in an airstrike.

“I can’t endure this,” she cried, her voice trailing off. “Two of my sons, two, two, two.”

Within minutes, a frenzy erupted around her as news arrived that the Israeli military had

issued a warning about imminent strikes near the hospital in Tyre, a coastal city within the large swath of southern Lebanon where Israel has told residents to flee north. Other families waiting outside the hospital scattered, racing away on motorcycles toward the seaside. “Come on,” Ms. Kholeif’s neighbor said, lifting her off the curb and shuttling her into a car before Is-

raeli warplanes arrived overhead. Ms. Kholeif’s sons, 23-year-old Abdul Rahman Jadour and 30-year-old Ayman Jadour, were among several Syrian farmworkers killed in the strikes, according to relatives, hospital officials and rescue workers. They were the latest casualties in a war that has consumed Tyre. The fighting began after Hezbollah, the Iran-

backed militant group, fired on Israel last month in support of Tehran, prompting Israel to bombard and invade Lebanon. Ever since, Tyre has been transformed by fear. The city’s population is predominantly Shiite Muslim, the same sect as Hezbollah. Its busiest streets have emptied, the metal shutters have been pulled over storefronts, and residents are wary of leaving their homes. Despite a fragile cease-fire in Iran, Israel has vowed to keep striking Hezbollah and on Sunday, two Israeli attacks on towns in southern Lebanon killed at least 11 people, according to Lebanon’s official news agency. That followed a barrage on Wednesday that killed more than 300 people, the deadliest day since the war began. Littered across the roads are the remains of Israeli airstrikes. There are buildings with their facades sheared off. Entire rooms of apartments were hurled across the road and lie on top of mounds of rubble. Poking through the wreckage are signs of the lives once lived there: A doll with blond hair. A black and bright green roller blade. The severed half of a

Options Dwindle as Deal Fails to Materialize

By **TYLER PAGER** and **DAVID E. SANGER**

Vice President JD Vance’s failure to win the concessions the United States sought from Iran in a single marathon negotiating session over its nuclear program was no surprise. But what now?

The failure leaves the Trump administration facing several unpalatable options: a lengthy negotiation with Tehran over the future of its nuclear program, or a resumption of a war that has already created the largest energy disruption in modern times, and the prospect of a long struggle over who controls the Strait of Hormuz.

President Trump said on Sunday that the United States would blockade the Strait of Hormuz, putting the already brittle truce into further uncertainty. Mr. Trump’s blockade threat came hours after Mr. Vance left the talks in Islamabad.

Mr. Vance said little about what took place during more than 21 hours of negotiations, suggesting he had handed the Iranians a take-it-or-leave-it proposal to forever terminate their nuclear program, and they left it.

“We’ve made very clear what our red lines are,” Mr. Vance told reporters, “what things we’re willing to accommodate them on.” He added, “They have chosen not to accept our terms.”

In that respect, this negotiation appears to have differed little from the one that ended in deadlock in Geneva in late February, leading Mr. Trump to order what became 38 days of missile and bombing attacks across Iran, aimed at its missile stockpiles, its military bases and the industrial base inside Iran that produces new weaponry.

But Mr. Trump’s bet, one he described several times over the past month, was that Iran would change its mind once faced with a huge demonstration of American military prowess, with more than 13,000 targets hit, according to the Pentagon. The Iranians, for their part, were determined to show that no amount of American ordinance would force them to give way.

“The heavy loss of our great elders, dear ones, and fellow countrymen has made our response to pursue the Iranian nation’s interests and rights firmer than ever before,” the Iranian foreign ministry said in a statement as Mr. Vance headed to a military airfield to leave for home, empty-handed for now.

Perhaps that will change. But

Military Says No Shipping to or From Iran

This article is by **Katie Rogers, Farnaz Fassihi and Thomas Fuller.**

Hours after the United States failed to reach a deal to end the war in Iran, President Trump on Sunday sought to ratchet up pressure on Tehran, vowing to blockade the Strait of Hormuz, a crucial waterway for Iran and the global economy.

“Effective immediately, the United States Navy, the Finest in the World, will begin the process of BLOCKADING any and all Ships trying to enter, or leave, the Strait of Hormuz,” Mr. Trump said on social media Sunday morning.

He added, “Any Iranian who fires at us, or at peaceful vessels, will be BLOWN TO HELL!”

U.S. Central Command later clarified details of the blockade in a social media message, saying it would begin at 10 a.m. Eastern time on Monday but that it would apply only to “maritime traffic entering and exiting Iranian ports.”

The clarification appeared to soften Mr. Trump’s earlier vow of a complete blockade of the strait. The U.S. military “will not impede freedom of navigation for vessels transiting the Strait of Hormuz to and from non-Iranian ports,” Central Command said in the message.

In threatening the blockade, Mr. Trump appeared to be trying to strip Iran of the leverage the waterway has provided Tehran since the start of the war six weeks ago. Iran’s selective closure of the strait prompted a surge in gasoline prices and inflation in the United States.

A blockade of the strait would most likely keep gasoline prices high and could be perilous for countries in Asia that rely heavily on Gulf energy supplies.

Two top Iranian officials responded defiantly on Sunday to the U.S. announcement. Mohsen Rezaei, a former commander who is now a senior adviser to the supreme leader, Mojtaba Khamenei, said Iran had “large, untouched levers” to counter any naval blockade and that the country would not be pressured “with tweets and imaginary plans.”

And Iran’s chief negotiator and the speaker of its Parliament, Mohammad Bagher Ghalibaf, separately warned American consumers: “Soon you’ll be nostalgic for \$4-\$5 gas.”

The president’s announcement came hours after Vice President JD Vance left a marathon session of peace talks in Islamabad without a breakthrough.

Iran relies heavily on revenue from oil that it exports through the strait, and more recently it has

Orban Concedes in Hungary, Slowing Global Tilt to the Right

By **ANDREW HIGGINS** and **LILI RUTAI**

BUDAPEST — Prime Minister Viktor Orban of Hungary, a lode-star for MAGA culture warriors and right-wing populists in Europe, conceded defeat on Sunday in a general election, breaking the momentum of a global nationalist revival promoted by President Trump.

In a surprisingly early and gracious concession speech in Budapest, Mr. Orban congratulated the opposition, saying, “The responsibility and opportunity to govern were not given to us.” But he also made a vow: “We are not giving

up. Never, never, never.” His defeat paves the way for Peter Magyar, a former Orban loyalist and the leader of the main opposition party, to take over as Hungary’s prime minister once the newly elected Parliament meets.

“We have done it,” Mr. Magyar told a cheering crowd gathered with flags on the bank of the River Danube. “We have liberated Hungary and have taken back our country.”

Sunday’s vote was widely seen

State Judges, Feeling Unsafe As Threats Rise, Turn to Guns

By **KATIE J.M. BAKER**

In an animated video, a man in an American-flag-print face mask who called himself “the Patriot” tracked his target, Judge Jennifer Johnson, with a hatchet in his hand.

The man followed a cartoon version of the judge, who sits on a county court in rural Florida, down a sidewalk as he muttered insults about her appearance and shared personal details about her marriage and children. Then he announced that it was “takedown time.”

“Judge Johnson, let’s bury the

hatchet,” the man said, striking his virtual target in the back until she fell to the ground. Then he swapped the hatchet for a gun and shot her in the head. As blood pooled around her corpse, the man celebrated her “execution.”

Judge Johnson knew exactly who had made the video, which was uploaded to YouTube and TikTok in September 2023. The man had been threatening her since soon after she heard his child dependency case in 2016, at one point calling her “target number



Earth Reunion The four Artemis II astronauts made an emotional return to Houston after a 10-day lunar journey ended Friday. Page A12.

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Stampede in Haiti Kills Dozens The tragedy occurred around the sighting of a social media personality at the Citadelle Laferrière, a fortress symbolizing sovereignty. PAGE A10

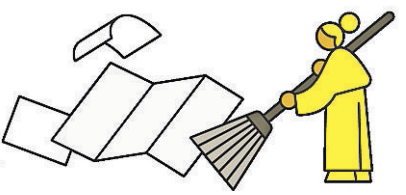
South Korea’s Medical Crisis Hundreds of patients each year have trouble finding emergency care in a nation with a world-class medical system. Such delays can be fatal. PAGE A6

Jailed for Singing Love Songs Nguyen Van Loc was persecuted for performing Hanoi’s old romantic music during and after the Vietnam War. Still, he always returns to the stage. PAGE A4

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A.I. Revamps Cybersecurity With new systems from companies like Anthropic and OpenAI, hackers attack faster. The defense is more A.I. PAGE B1

Financial Spring Cleaning While the world feels uncertain, spend this season taking charge of what you can control: your budget. PAGE B1



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Swalwell’s Supporters Vanish The implosion of the U.S. House member’s campaign for California governor revealed the shallowness of his relationships in the state. PAGE A13

The Winds of History An unlikely coalition stopped a turbine project planned near a camp that once held Japanese Americans. PAGE A16

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Trailblazing Talk-Radio Host With “Night Talk,” Bob Law gave the Black community a voice, often hosting famous figures. He was 86. PAGE A20

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An Entertaining Villain As the lead of “The Audacity,” Billy Magnussen plays a particularly poignant variety: the tech bro. PAGE C1

Etiquette for ‘Rocky Horror’ The new musical is trying to rein in the audience participation that fans like the ones below are used to. PAGE C1



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Not Waiting for the Hall to Call As an N.B.A. coach, Dick Motta won 935 games and the 1978 championship. At 94, he isn’t seeking validation. PAGE D1

A Shrine, Sponsored by ... Some in Los Angeles are balking at a deal renaming their ballpark UniQlo Field at Dodger Stadium. PAGE D3

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